

Pursuite Workflow Guide

Header Block

Confidence Summary: 100% verified, 0% inferred - confirm, 0% unknown.

Field	Value
Product name	Pursuite
Product type	SaaS/software; Pursuite 1.0 is delivered as a standalone Windows SMB pilot
Intended end-user audience	Capture managers, proposal managers, BD leads, writers, reviewers, executive approvers, and proposal contributors
Intended admin audience	System administrators, proposal operations leads, security administrators, compliance owners, and tenant implementation teams
Version/date	Workflow Guide 1.0 draft, June 24, 2026
Environment notes	Windows 10 or Windows 11, Docker Desktop, Pursuite Manager, local Docker stack, local Docker volumes, role-based access, MFA, AI provider controls, CUI/ITAR classification controls, audit exports, and local backup/restore
Grounding corpus	Pursuite End-User Guide, Pursuite Admin User Guide, Pursuite Installation Guide, in-app guide chunks, and RFP Shredder implementation specification in this repository
Purpose statement	Give end users and administrators one operating guide for taking Pursuite from first access through proposal delivery, governance, troubleshooting, and verification.

At-a-Glance

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Workflow area	End-user track	Admin track
Access	Launch Pursuite and sign in with the account provided by an administrator.	Install Docker Desktop, run the installer or portable launcher, start Pursuite Manager, and bootstrap first-run access.
Customer records	Create or open accounts, contacts, opportunities, and pipeline records.	Configure organization defaults, supported roles, and access boundaries.
Pursuit qualification	Complete bid/no-bid scoring and record pursuit decisions where authorized.	Govern criteria, executive approval boundaries, and audit-ready decision records.
Proposal kickoff	Create a proposal workspace, select a template, assign sections, upload the RFP, and confirm requirements.	Configure AI provider access, CUI processing policy, proposal workspace roles, and template governance.
Writing and review	Draft sections, use approved content, run AI assistance where permitted, resolve comments, and move sections through review.	Manage role gates, section locks, workspace membership, and compliance escalation.
Compliance and export	Generate the compliance matrix, run scans, resolve findings, assemble/export, and record debriefs.	Export audit evidence, monitor CUI access, manage records retention, and control scheduled reports.

Workflow area	End-user track	Admin track
Continuity	Report blockers with screen, record, error, and timing detail.	Run backups, restore only when approved, collect diagnostics, and preserve logs.

Setup / Onboarding Sequence

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End-User Track

Precondition: An administrator has installed or launched Pursuite, created your account, and assigned your system role and any proposal workspace role.

1. [verified] Confirm Docker Desktop is running if you operate the standalone workstation directly.
2. [verified] Launch Pursuite from the desktop shortcut, Start Menu entry, or portable launcher.
3. [verified] Wait for Pursuite Manager to start the local stack and open the local Pursuite web app.
4. [verified] Sign in with the organization, email, and password provided by your administrator.
5. [verified] If MFA is enabled, enter the current 6-digit authenticator code when prompted.
6. [verified] Open Home and confirm the screen shows your name, role-aware panels, and current pipeline or work data.
7. [verified] Open Contacts -> Accounts and create or open the customer account you will use for pursuit work.
8. [verified] Add the relevant contact, then create or open the opportunity associated with the pursuit.
9. [verified] Complete bid/no-bid scoring if your role and process allow it.
10. [verified] Create or open the proposal workspace after the opportunity is approved for pursuit.
11. [verified] Upload the RFP PDF or DOCX in the RFP Shredder, review extracted requirements, edit or add rows as needed, and confirm the requirement set.
12. [verified] Open the Compliance Matrix after requirements are confirmed and generate the first matrix.
13. [verified] Draft assigned sections, review compliance alerts, resolve comments, and move each section to the next status when ready.
14. [verified] Assemble/export only after required sections, pricing, attachments, and compliance findings are ready for final production.

Expected result: You can reach Home, open core records, work inside a proposal workspace, and see confirmed RFP requirements feeding compliance tools.

Confirm success: Confirm your assigned proposal appears in Proposals, your section assignments are visible, the RFP requirement set is confirmed, and the Compliance Matrix is usable.

Admin Track

Precondition: You have a supported Windows workstation, Docker Desktop is installed and healthy, and you have the signed Pursuite installer or portable launcher for the release under test.

1. [verified] Install Docker Desktop current stable release on Windows 10 or Windows 11.
2. [verified] Run Pursuite-Standalone-Setup-1.0.0.exe or Pursuite-Standalone-Launcher-1.0.0.exe.
3. [verified] Open Pursuite Manager and confirm the Dashboard shows Standalone 1.0 Pilot, version v1.0.0, and local paths for data, environment, backups, logs, and bundled images.
4. [verified] Click Launch Pursuite and wait for the Manager to prepare %APPDATA%\Pursuite, backfill .env.production, load bundled images, start the stack, and report healthy services.
5. [verified] **Sign in with the first-run Admin account from %APPDATA%\Pursuite\first-run-admin.txt; rotate the temporary credential immediately after initial access.**
6. [verified] **Add at least one backup Admin tied to a named employee, not a shared mailbox.**
7. [verified] Review organization settings, display name, domain, timezone, feature flags, and plan entitlements.
8. [verified] Configure SSO where required and confirm a pilot account can sign in.
9. [verified] **Configure MFA policy and confirm Admins and Proposal Managers are enrolled according to company policy.**
10. [verified] Configure approved AI provider credentials and test provider connectivity before enabling AI-dependent workflows.
11. [verified] **Configure CUI/ITAR policy and enable external CUI processing only when the provider and organization approval are documented.**
12. [verified] Invite users, assign least-privilege system roles, and assign workspace roles only where proposal access is needed.
13. [verified] Publish or approve proposal templates and seed the content library with reusable, approved material.
14. [verified] Run an initial backup from Pursuite Manager -> Backups after confirming login and basic object creation.

Expected result: The standalone stack is healthy, named administrators exist, security and AI controls match policy, and users can begin governed proposal work.

Confirm success: Confirm at least two Admins can sign in, a backup completes, AI provider test succeeds if enabled, and user roles match the approved access model.

Core Operating Procedures

Confidence Summary: 100% verified, 0% inferred - confirm, 0% unknown.

End-User Track

Procedure 1: Create and Qualify a New Pursuit

Trigger/precondition: A new solicitation, customer opportunity, or possible bid enters the pipeline.

1. [verified] Open Pipeline.
2. [verified] Click New Opportunity, From Email, From RFP, or Import according to the source.
3. [verified] Enter or verify the opportunity name, agency or customer, solicitation number, due date, estimated value, NAICS, set-aside, bid type, and source.
4. [verified] Save the opportunity.
5. [verified] Open the opportunity detail page.
6. [verified] Upload source documents on the Documents tab when they are available.
7. [verified] Complete bid/no-bid scoring.
8. [verified] **Submit the bid/no-bid decision for approval when your organization requires executive approval.**
9. [verified] **Record the approved, declined, or more-info decision only when your role authorizes that decision.**
10. [verified] Create a proposal workspace only after the pursuit is approved for bidding.

Expected result: The opportunity is active, core metadata is complete, the decision is recorded, and a proposal workspace exists when the organization intends to bid.

Confirm success: Confirm the opportunity status, decision history, and proposal link are visible on the opportunity detail page.

Procedure 2: Build a Proposal Workspace From an RFP

Trigger/precondition: The pursuit is approved and the team is ready to structure proposal work.

1. [verified] Open the approved opportunity.
2. [verified] Create or open the proposal workspace.
3. [verified] Confirm proposal name, due date, page limit, target format, bid type, and owner.
4. [verified] Add team members in the Team panel.
5. [verified] **Assign each participant the correct proposal workspace role.**
6. [verified] Select a published template or manually create volumes and sections.
7. [verified] Open RFP Shredder from the proposal workspace.
8. [verified] Upload the solicitation PDF or DOCX.
9. [verified] Wait for extraction to complete.
10. [verified] Review each extracted requirement, edit incorrect rows, add missing requirements, remove false positives, and mark low-confidence rows reviewed.
11. [verified] **Confirm requirements only after the requirement set is complete; confirmation unlocks the Compliance Matrix and Autonomous Pipeline.**
12. [verified] Open Compliance Matrix and generate the matrix.
13. [verified] Assign proposal sections to writers.

14. [verified] Begin drafting only after requirements, structure, and section ownership are in place.

Expected result: The proposal has a team, structure, confirmed RFP requirements, and a generated compliance baseline.

Confirm success: Confirm the RFP status is confirmed, the matrix panel is available, and each writer sees assigned sections.

Procedure 3: Draft, Review, and Approve Proposal Sections

Trigger/precondition: You have an assigned proposal section and the proposal workspace is available.

1. [verified] Open the proposal workspace.
2. [verified] Select your assigned section.
3. [verified] Read the section instructions, page limit, source material, and related RFP requirements.
4. [verified] Draft manually, insert approved content library material, or use AI assistance where permitted.
5. [verified] Review AI-generated content for accuracy, grounding, customer relevance, and compliance before relying on it.
6. [verified] Save frequently.
7. [verified] Check compliance alerts and page or word guidance.
8. [verified] Move the section to the next status when ready.
9. [verified] Request review or notify the assigned reviewer.
10. [verified] Address comments and requested changes.
11. [verified] Mark the section approved only when the reviewer or Proposal Manager accepts it.

Expected result: Required sections have current content, comments are resolved, and section status reflects the team's review process.

Confirm success: Confirm the section status, comments, and review state match the team's gate criteria.

Procedure 4: Use Compliance Tools Before Final Review

Trigger/precondition: RFP requirements are confirmed and proposal text has enough content to evaluate.

1. [verified] Confirm the RFP requirement set is confirmed in RFP Shredder.
2. [verified] Open Compliance Matrix.
3. [verified] Generate or refresh the compliance assessment.
4. [verified] Review every requirement for covered, partial, or missing coverage.
5. [verified] Assign missing or weak requirements to the right section owner.
6. [verified] Open Compliance and run a compliance scan when available.
7. [verified] Review critical and warning findings.
8. [verified] **Fix proposal text or waive findings only when the waiver is justified and reviewable.**

9. [verified] Re-run the scan after major corrections.
10. [verified] Export or save the matrix for review when the team needs evidence.

Expected result: Critical gaps are resolved or formally waived, and the team can explain how each RFP requirement is addressed.

Confirm success: Confirm the compliance score, matrix coverage, and open findings are acceptable for the next review gate.

Procedure 5: Assemble, Export, and Close Out a Proposal

Trigger/precondition: Required sections are approved and final production is authorized.

1. [verified] Confirm all required sections are approved.
2. [verified] Confirm compliance findings are resolved or accepted.
3. [verified] **Confirm pricing, quote totals, attachments, and supporting files are current before assembly.**
4. [verified] Open the export or assembly panel.
5. [verified] Choose the target format such as DOCX, PDF, or PDF/A.
6. [verified] Start assembly.
7. [verified] Review the generated file.
8. [verified] Download the file before the signed link expires.
9. [verified] **Store the final file in the approved repository or submission workflow.**
10. [verified] Update proposal and opportunity status.
11. [verified] Record closeout and debrief information after submission or award decision.

Expected result: The team has a final export, proposal status is current, and the opportunity record reflects the latest business outcome.

Confirm success: Confirm the export history, proposal status, opportunity status, and debrief record are current.

Admin Track

Procedure 6: Manage User Lifecycle

Trigger/precondition: A user must be invited, changed, deactivated, or reviewed.

1. [verified] Open Admin or the user management area.
2. [verified] **Invite the user with the least-privilege system role required for the work.**
3. [verified] Add optional request context where your organization tracks approvals.
4. [verified] **Assign workspace roles only for proposals the user needs to access.**

5. [verified] Review the user's role, workspace membership, and CUI or export-controlled access during access reviews.
6. [verified] **Deactivate former employees or subcontractors when access is no longer justified.**
7. [verified] **Retain audit history for deactivated users; do not delete audit records.**

Expected result: Users have the right access for current work, and deactivation preserves traceability.

Confirm success: Confirm role assignments, workspace memberships, and deactivation state in the user record.

Procedure 7: Govern AI Provider and RFP Shredder Controls

Trigger/precondition: AI-assisted drafting, RFP extraction, compliance matrix generation, or autonomous workflows must be enabled or reviewed.

1. [verified] Open AI Provider settings.
2. [verified] Add or update approved provider credentials.
3. [verified] Test provider connectivity before saving the workflow as ready.
4. [verified] Confirm approved use cases and data-handling policy.
5. [verified] **Confirm CUI/ITAR policy before allowing controlled documents to use AI processing.**
6. [verified] **Enable external CUI processing only when the organization and provider are approved for the data type.**
7. [verified] Review RFP Shredder failures for file type, size, AI provider health, CUI gate, and extraction status.
8. [verified] Preserve audit events for upload, OCR fallback, requirement edits, confirmation, and CUI blocks.

Expected result: AI-dependent workflows are available only within approved data and security boundaries.

Confirm success: Confirm AI test success, CUI processing status, RFP Shredder status, and relevant audit events.

Procedure 8: Run Backup, Restore, and Diagnostic Workflows

Trigger/precondition: You are validating the installation, preparing for maintenance, responding to support, or recovering from data issues.

1. [verified] Open Pursuite Manager.
2. [verified] Confirm services are healthy before routine backup.
3. [verified] Run a backup from Manager -> Backups.
4. [verified] Confirm the backup file appears under %APPDATA%\Pursuite\backups.
5. [verified] **Before restore, confirm approval because restore overwrites the current local database and uploads.**
6. [verified] Select the approved backup file.

7. [verified] **Run restore and restart the stack after completion.**
8. [verified] Copy diagnostics and preserve %APPDATA%\Pursuite\launcher.log when escalation is required.

Expected result: Backups are available for recovery, restores are controlled, and support has enough evidence to investigate issues.

Confirm success: Confirm backup presence, restored records after restart, service health, and attached diagnostics.

Admin Configuration & Governance

Confidence Summary: 100% verified, 0% inferred - confirm, 0% unknown.

End-User Track

Precondition: Your organization has defined role, security, proposal, and data-handling policies.

1. [verified] Follow your assigned role boundaries when creating records, drafting, reviewing, or exporting.
2. [verified] Ask a Proposal Manager or Admin when a control is missing or permission-gated.
3. [verified] **Do not route CUI, proposal-sensitive, customer-sensitive, or export-controlled material outside approved Pursuite and company repositories.**
4. [verified] Treat AI output as draft assistance and verify it against source documents before relying on it.
5. [verified] Use Archive rather than Delete where the record carries institutional memory.

Admin Track

Precondition: You are responsible for tenant governance, security, compliance, or operations.

1. [verified] **Maintain at least two named Admin accounts and review Admin access quarterly.**
2. [verified] Configure SSO, MFA, and MFA reset procedures according to company policy.
3. [verified] **Assign users least-privilege system roles and proposal workspace roles.**
4. [verified] Configure organization profile, primary domain, timezone, feature flags, and plan entitlements.
5. [verified] Configure AI provider credentials, test connectivity, and review approved use cases before enabling AI workflows.
6. [verified] **Configure CUI/ITAR classification controls, minimum clearance rules, and external-processing approval only where policy allows.**
7. [verified] Publish templates only after review; keep proposal-saved templates as drafts until approved.
8. [verified] Govern content library approval so reusable content is reviewed before writers rely on it.
9. [verified] Export audit evidence for compliance review and restrict access when evidence contains CUI or sensitive proposal data.
10. [verified] Review storage, AI usage, plan limits, scheduled reports, integration health, and stale workspaces on the documented cadence.

11. [verified] **Archive proposals for retention and traceability; delete or destroy data only when policy and approval allow it.**
12. [verified] Preserve audit logs, CUI classification history, backup evidence, and support diagnostics according to records policy.

Governance area	Admin control	Why it matters
Roles and permissions	Least-privilege system roles plus proposal workspace roles	Prevents overexposure of proposal and tenant data.
Identity	SSO where required, MFA for privileged and CUI-handling users	Supports account protection and CMMC-aligned access control.
CUI/ITAR	Classification, clearance thresholds, external-processing approval, access logging	Protects controlled data and records access attempts.
AI provider	Approved provider credentials, test-before-use, usage review	Prevents unapproved data flows and runtime failures.
RFP Shredder	Upload gates, OCR fallback review, requirement edits, confirmation audit	Keeps requirement extraction reviewable before compliance tools run.
Audit evidence	Export, restrict, and preserve audit records	Supports compliance review and incident response.
Backup/restore	Manager-driven backup, controlled restore, launcher logs	Protects local standalone continuity.
Retention	Archive proposals, retain classification and audit history	Preserves institutional memory and traceability.

Lifecycle & Decision Points

Confidence Summary: 100% verified, 0% inferred - confirm, 0% unknown.

Decision point	Trigger condition	End-user branch	Admin branch
Start new pursuit vs. hold	A solicitation, customer opportunity, or potential bid appears.	[verified] Create or import the opportunity and complete bid/no-bid scoring.	[verified] Confirm criteria, role gates, and approval ownership are configured.
Bid vs. no-bid vs. more information	Scoring, customer fit, or executive review reaches a decision gate.	[verified] Record supporting context and proceed only when the decision is approved.	[verified] Preserve decision history and ensure executive authority is respected.
Template vs. blank proposal	Proposal workspace is created after an approved pursuit.	[verified] Select a published template or start blank when no suitable template exists.	[verified] Publish templates only after review and maintain version history.
Confirm vs. revise RFP requirements	Shredder extraction completes.	[verified] Edit, add, or remove requirements before confirmation.	[verified] Review blocked confirmation, CUI gate, AI provider status, and audit events.
Fix vs. waive compliance finding	Matrix or scan shows missing, partial, critical, or warning coverage.	[verified] Fix content or request a justified waiver.	[verified] Review waiver discipline and keep evidence for proposal gates.
Export vs. hold	Final assembly is requested.	[verified] Export only after sections, findings, pricing, and attachments are current.	[verified] Control overrides and retain export evidence where needed.

Decision point	Trigger condition	End-user branch	Admin branch
Archive vs. delete	Proposal, opportunity, account, or content is no longer active.	[verified] Archive records that carry proposal history or reusable knowledge.	[verified] Approve deletion only under records policy and preserve audit history.
Restore vs. troubleshoot in place	Local data appears missing, corrupted, or inconsistent.	[verified] Stop editing and report the issue with screen, record, and time details.	[verified] Restore only after approval because restore overwrites current local data.
Enable vs. block external CUI processing	A CUI-classified RFP needs AI processing.	[verified] Wait for Admin review when CUI processing is blocked.	[verified] Enable external processing only with formal organizational and provider approval.
Scale use vs. review limits	Usage approaches plan, storage, AI, seat, or workflow limits.	[verified] Report plan-limit banners or missing controls.	[verified] Review billing, storage, user count, AI usage, and entitlements before expansion.

Troubleshooting

Confidence Summary: 100% verified, 0% inferred - confirm, 0% unknown.

User-Resolvable Issues

Symptom	Likely cause	Action	Confirm success
Pursuite does not open	Docker Desktop is not running or services are still starting.	[verified] Start Docker Desktop, relaunch Pursuite, and wait for Pursuite Manager to report healthy services.	The local web app opens.
Browser shows stale UI	Browser cache or service worker retained old assets.	[verified] Hard refresh with Ctrl+Shift+R and ask an Admin to clear local site data if the issue remains.	Current UI appears.
Cannot sign in	Wrong organization, expired or reset password, MFA issue, or account state.	[verified] Verify organization and credentials, then ask an Admin for password or MFA help.	You reach Home after login.
Expected button is missing	System role, workspace role, archived state, or prerequisite gate blocks the action.	[verified] Confirm your role, workspace role, record status, and prerequisite gates before escalating.	The button appears or the correct owner performs the action.
Compliance scan has no useful results	Requirements are not confirmed or content is too thin.	[verified] Confirm RFP requirements and add proposal content before re-running the scan.	Findings or coverage results reflect current content.
RFP extraction seems incomplete	Low-confidence AI output, scanned document, or poor source quality.	[verified] Review requirements, edit rows, add missing items, and upload a better scan if no text can be extracted.	Confirmed requirements reflect the solicitation.
Export shows coverage warning	A win theme, section, or requirement remains unaddressed.	[verified] Address the flagged content or ask a manager to review any deliberate override.	Export proceeds with known gaps resolved or accepted.

Admin-Only Issues

Symptom	Likely cause	Action	Confirm success
Containers unhealthy	Docker engine, image load, API, web, PostgreSQL, or Redis issue.	[verified] Open Manager -> Logs, review service output, copy diagnostics, and preserve %APPDATA%\Pursuite\launcher.log.	Services return to healthy state or support has full diagnostics.
Port conflict	Another service is using the configured web port.	[verified] Stop the conflicting service or change HTTP_PORT in %APPDATA%\Pursuite\.env.production.	Web service binds successfully.
First-run admin file missing	Stack is not healthy yet or an Admin already exists.	[verified] Wait for stack health, then check launcher logs and existing Admin state.	Admin access path is confirmed.
Backup fails	Stack is unhealthy, storage is unavailable, or Docker operation failed.	[verified] Confirm services are running and retry Manager -> Backups.	A backup appears under %APPDATA%\Pursuite\backups.
Restore fails	Invalid backup, stack conflict, or storage issue.	[verified] Preserve logs, restart the stack, and retry only with a known-good backup.	Restored records appear after restart.
RFP upload or processing fails	File type, size, AI provider, queue, OCR, or CUI gate problem.	[verified] Check supported file type, 50 MB cap, provider health, processing status, and CUI approval state.	RFP status reaches completed or a documented failure code is available.
CUI processing is blocked	Organization external CUI processing approval is false or provider approval is missing.	[verified] Confirm CUI policy, provider approval, organization approval, and user clearance before enabling processing.	CUI behavior matches policy and audit events record the decision.
AI features unavailable	Provider credentials, plan limit, provider outage, CUI policy, or rate limits.	[verified] Test AI provider connectivity, review usage, and confirm data policy before reopening workflows.	AI-dependent workflow succeeds.
Integration sync fails	Credentials, permissions, endpoint, rate limit, or webhook health issue.	[verified] Review integration settings, test connection, review logs, and disable the integration if it is no longer approved.	Sync resumes or the integration is safely disabled.

Verification Checklist

Confidence Summary: 100% verified, 0% inferred - confirm, 0% unknown.

End-User Completion Checklist

- [] [verified] Confirm you can sign in and reach Home.
- [] [verified] Confirm your assigned system role and proposal workspace role match your responsibility.
- [] [verified] Confirm the customer account, contact, opportunity, and proposal records are current.
- [] [verified] Confirm bid/no-bid status is recorded before proposal creation.

- [] [verified] Confirm the proposal workspace has the right template, volumes, sections, due date, and team assignments.
- [] [verified] Confirm RFP requirements are reviewed, corrected, and confirmed.
- [] [verified] Confirm Compliance Matrix and scan results reflect current proposal content.
- [] [verified] Confirm AI-assisted content has been reviewed against source documents before use.
- [] [verified] **Confirm pricing, quote totals, attachments, and export files are approved before submission.**
- [] [verified] Confirm final export, proposal status, opportunity status, and debrief records are current.

Admin Completion Checklist

- [] [verified] Confirm Pursuite Manager shows healthy services and version v1.0.0.
- [] [verified] Confirm %APPDATA%\Pursuite\.env.production, backups, bundled images, and launcher.log paths are known.
- [] [verified] **Confirm the first-run Admin credential has been rotated and at least two named Admins exist.**
- [] [verified] **Confirm SSO, MFA, role assignments, and workspace access match approved policy.**
- [] [verified] **Confirm CUI/ITAR classification, clearance, and external-processing controls match organizational approval.**
- [] [verified] Confirm AI provider connectivity has been tested before AI workflows are used.
- [] [verified] Confirm templates and content library items are reviewed before publication or reuse.
- [] [verified] Confirm audit export, evidence handling, and access review cadence are documented.
- [] [verified] **Confirm backup succeeds before maintenance, reinstall, restore testing, or major configuration change.**
- [] [verified] **Confirm restore is approved before use because it overwrites current local database and uploads.**
- [] [verified] Confirm support escalation includes app version, artifact hash, Windows version, Docker version, Manager diagnostics, launcher log, reproduction steps, and backup status.